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CRYPTOCURRENCY

Bullish pops 89% on first day of trading, riding crypto hype

By [Rosie Bradbury](#)

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Tom Farley, CEO of Bullish, celebrates after ringing the opening bell at the New York Stock Exchange on Wednesday.
| Michael M. Santiago/Getty Images

[Bullish](#), a Cayman Islands-based cryptocurrency exchange that caters to institutional investors, flew past its opening price on the NYSE in another stellar debut of the summer, closing out the day at \$70 per share.

The closing day price, an 89% pop from its IPO pricing at \$37 per share, brings Bullish’s fully diluted market cap to just over \$10 billion.

The strong pop was especially remarkable, given that Bullish allocated about 20% of its IPO offering to retail investors, about twice the typical amount—a decision that can temper demand in an IPO debut by softening buying pressure in the first few hours of trading.

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Bullish reportedly made the decision in order to prevent the same stock price surge that [Figma saw in its IPO](#) earlier this month.

The crypto IPO market is gearing up for a long-awaited rebound: Bullish's IPO comes off the back of [Circle's blockbuster listing](#), which has risen over 120% since its debut. Like Circle, Bullish had previously planned to go public via SPAC in 2021 but called off the \$9 billion planned merger in late 2022.

That decision is looking like a lucrative one, particularly for Bullish's early investors, which include Pu Luo Chung VC, Alexander See and [Galaxy Digital Ventures](#). [Thiel Capital](#), which invested in Bullish's \$400 million round, owns less than 5% of shares.

Bullish's strong debut comes in spite of its rocky financial performance: Bullish recorded a net loss of \$348 million in Q1 2025, a huge swing from a \$105 million quarterly profit a year earlier. Its net income of \$79 million for the year ending Dec. 31, 2024, was also a dramatic decrease from last year's \$1.3 billion.

Its IPO performance, coinciding with the S&P 500 and Nasdaq closing record-breaking highs on Tuesday, will likely bring more cryptocurrency startups out of the woodwork and into the public markets.

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About [Rosie Bradbury](#)

Rosie Bradbury is a senior reporter covering startups and venture capital for PitchBook News. Based in New York, she previously reported for the Bureau of Investigative Journalism, Business Insider and Wired. Rosie studied history and politics at the University of Cambridge.

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